👩🏾‍🏫 Staff Guide · Poinsettia Care & Pinching (Level 2)

Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · goes with the class “Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions” (4 pts per week). Level 2 = about 3rd-grade reading. Same activity, same day, same points as the class.

1. The pieces

- **Task card**: Modified from the class “Care chart + Pinching Plants + Growing Instructions”. 8 steps, one per box.
- **Prep sheet**: jobs, tools checklist, safety. Do it the day before or at the start.
- **Slides**: jobs, safety, steps, 3 checks.
- **Reflection**: replaces the written parts.
- **Game**: on the class site.

2. Prompts while they work

- Show me the first step.
- Which tool do we need now?
- Where do our hands go when the tool is cutting?
- What should we do when we finish?

3. Modifications

- Task card instead of written directions
- Sentence starters on the reflection
- Partner reads directions aloud

4. What to grade (4 pts per week)

- Steps done (photo proof)
- Reflection: 2 sentences per box
- Pointing, saying, or circling counts as a full answer.
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

5. Ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE).

⚠️ Safety: tools and plants

- **Tools**: students may use all tools (pruners, knives, floral wire, low-temp glue guns) **with an adult right there**. Staff hand tools out, stay at the station, and count them back in. Cut-resistant gloves if possible.
- **Poinsettia sap** is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Gloves on, no rubbing eyes, wash hands after.
- **Latex**: poinsettias are in the latex family. Students with a latex allergy wear non-latex (nitrile) gloves or skip handling; check health plans.
- **Bees and pollen**: check IEP/health plans for bee-sting or pollen allergies and know where the EpiPen is before greenhouse work.
- **Mouths**: no plants, soil, seeds, berries, fertilizer or rooting hormone in mouths. Students who mouth objects or have pica need one-to-one eyes in the greenhouse. Many plants (holly and mistletoe berries, some houseplants) are poisonous.
- **Chemicals**: rooting hormone and fertilizer with gloves, then wash hands. Pesticides and growth regulators are staff/teacher only; students never spray or handle them.
- **Greenhouse**: wet floors and hoses (slips), heat (water breaks), wet dry potting mix first (dust).